A-A-30161
May 28, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TEST PACK, AIR REMOVAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description describes a disposable test pack used to test the air removal from prevacuum steam sterilizers (Bowie-Dick Test).

Salient characteristics. These test packs are to be equivalent, as shown in scientific experiments, to the reusable test pack described in guidelines established by the Association for the Advancement of Medical Instrumentation (AAMI). The test pack consists of layers of materials resistant to the passage of air and a pressure sensitive indicator used to interpret the results. A satisfactory test is indicated by the complete and uniform color change of the pressure sensitive indicator. The test pack provides a reliable and sensitive measure to detect air leaks, pump malfunctions and other vacuum failures that could adversely affect the sterilization process.

Instructions on use, placement in the sterilizer, operation of the sterilizer and interpretation of test results are to be provided with each test pack or in the shipping container.

The test pack shall be plainly marked with the manufacturer's name and product number. Other acceptable markings include instructions for use and interpretation of test results. Markings shall not be affected by the sterilization process.

The test pack shall be free of dirt, grease, or loose foreign matter.

Workmanship. The test pack shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One Package containing 50 to 80 test packs usually provided by the manufacturer as commercial practice, constitutes one unit. Unit shall be stated in the solicitation.

FSC 6550

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of zero (percent defective) and inspection level of S-1. Sampling for tests (dimensional), shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit or product for test purposes shall be one test pack.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with this commercial item description requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall

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within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereafter. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be the degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus

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reshipment from the receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be that usually provided by the supplier as commercial practice, and as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6530-01-355-4184 (Package of 80)
6530-01-355-4183 (Package of 80)
6530-01-224-6058 (Package of 50)

Copies of Federal Standard No. 376, Preferred Metric Units for General Use by the Federal Government and MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes, may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20420.

Ordering data. Purchasers should select from the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(b) Unit and number of test packs in the unit.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity:

DoD-MB

AGENT:

DLA-DM

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force -03

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS VANAC (904)
Agent VA-OSS VACO (92A)

Project No. 6530-2331

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